

purposes, it may be beneficial to display the time stamp along with the command, as shown below. To display the time stamp, you need to use the following code:

```
# export HISTTIMEFORMAT='%F %T '
# history | more

1 2014-08-05 19:22:39 service httpd restart
2 2014-08-05 19:22:39 exit
3 2014-08-05 19:22:39 id
4 2014-08-05 19:22:39 ls
```

2. How to execute a previous command that starts with a specific word

Type '!' followed by the starting few letters of the command that you would like to re-execute. In the following example, typing 'ps' and then pressing 'Enter' executed the previous command starting with 'ps', which is 'ps aux | grep yp'.

```
# !ps

ps aux | grep yp
root      16947  0.0  0.1 36516 1264 ?        Sl   13:10
0:00 ypbind
root      17503  0.0  0.0  4124   740 pts/0    S+   19:19
0:00 grep yp
```

3. How to erase duplicates across the whole history using HISTCONTROL

The *ignoredups* shown below removes duplicates only if they are consecutive commands. To eliminate duplicates across the whole history, set the *HISTCONTROL* to *erasedups* as shown below.

```
# export HISTCONTROL=erasedups
# pwd
# service httpd stop
# history | tail -3
38  pwd
39  service httpd stop
40  history | tail -3

# ls -ltr
# service httpd stop
# history | tail -6
35  export HISTCONTROL=erasedups
36  pwd
37  history | tail -3
38  ls -ltr
39  service httpd stop
```

Note that the previous *service httpd stop* after *pwd* got erased.

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Command line shortcuts

Here are some tips to speed up our work.

```
cmd1;cmd2
```

The above command will run *cmd1* and then execute *cmd2*.

```
cmd1 && cmd2
```

This will execute *cmd2* if *cmd1* is successful.

```
cmd1 || cmd2
```

The above sequence will run *cmd2* if *cmd1* is not successful.

```
Ctrl+a
```

This will move the control to the beginning of the line in CLI.

```
Ctrl+e
```

The command above will move the control to the end of line in CLI.

```
!ser:p
```

The above command will print the last command starting with 'ser'.

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Viewing random man pages while logging in through SSH

If you wish to view the random man pages of the Linux command while you log in through SSH, add the following line in the *.bashrc* file:

```
/usr/bin/man $(ls /bin | shuf | head -1)
```

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END

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The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.